GORGONZOLA PDO



THE BASICS

MAKE:	Soft
SUB MAKE:	Predominantly Rennet set cheese for further ripening
POST-MAKE:	Internal (blue) mould
SUB POST-MAKE:	Natural rind
TYPICAL AGE PROFILE:	Minimum 50 days for the largest wheels, but typically three to six months. Minimum 80 days for the Piccante variety
APPROXIMATE WEIGHT(S):	6-13kg
GEOGRAPHICAL ORIGIN:	Italy
PROTECTED STATUS:	PDO – made with pasteurised cows' milk in the Lombardy and Piedmont regions of Italy
SPECIES OF MILKING ANIMAL:	Cow
BREED OF COW:	Breed not specified
RAW/PASTEURISED MILK:	Pasteurised
VEGETARIAN/ANIMAL RENNET:	Animal rennet
COMMONLY ENCOUNTERED VARIATIONS:	Dolce and Piccante

THE STORY

The story goes that Gorgonzola was discovered more than a thousand years ago when a cheesemaker in Lombardy abandoned his curd overnight in pursuit of a beautiful woman. He returned the next morning and tried to cover up his mistake by adding fresh curds to the previous day's production. Little did he know that the higher acidity of the overnight curd would prevent it from knitting together with the new batch, leaving cracks for blue mould to develop.

Today, Gorgonzola is made in one process with pasteurised milk following the soft cheese process. Once the curds are drained in moulds, the cheese is dry-salted over several days before it is pierced to allow oxygen to activate the blue mould. Gorgonzola Dolce is often matured in slatted wooden belts to stop it from collapsing on itself.

THE CHARACTER

There are two types of Gorgonzola. Dolce (sweet), which makes up the vast majority of production, is soft and creamy with a delicate blue spice, while Piccante (spicy) is aged at higher temperatures and for longer so has a crumbly texture and stronger flavour.

The pink rind should not be eaten.

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PERFECT PARTNERS:

The sweetness of fruity reds and dessert wines work with both the creaminess of Gorgonzola Dolce and the spice of Piccante.

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